

Assessment

While children are working, ask yourself the following question:

- Are the students able to problem solve successfully with partners?

If they are able to do this, take notes on what you see these pairs doing and saying, and share these with your class. You may want to do this without mentioning names. If students are not, try to notice what is interfering: the way they are sitting, eye contact, etc. and share these observations with your students as well as goals for future partner work.

As you read over the children's work, ask yourself the following question:

- Were the students able to devise creative solutions to design problems?

This is a difficult skill for this age group, and the purpose of this activity is merely to provide beginning exposure to the scientific skill. However, if you notice students that shine in this area, take note of this so that so you can encourage that student's talent.

Standards

National Council of Teachers of English and International Reading Association Standards for the English Language Arts

All students must have opportunities to:

- Read a wide range of print and nonprint texts.
- Employ a wide range of strategies as they write and use different writing process elements appropriately to communicate with different audiences for a variety of purposes.
- Participate as knowledgeable, reflective, creative, and critical members of a variety of literacy communities.
- Use spoken, written, and visual language to accomplish their own purposes (e.g., for learning, enjoyment, persuasion, and the exchange of information).

National Science Education Standards

As a result of their activities in grades K–4, all students should develop:

- Understanding of properties of objects and materials (Physical Science).
- Abilities of technological design (Science and Technology).
- Understanding about science and technology (Science and Technology).
- Understanding of science as a human endeavor (History and Nature of Science).

